

MongoDB Aggregation



Objectives

After completing this lab, you will be able to:

- Describe simple aggregation operators that process and compute data such as \$sort, \$limit, \$group, \$sum, \$min, \$max, and \$avg
- Combine operators to create multi-stage aggregation pipelines
- Build aggregation pipelines that draw insights about the data by returning aggregated values

Exercise 1 - Getting the environment ready

Open the MongoDB database page by clicking the button below:



On that page, click the **Create** button to create a MongoDB database.

After creation has finished, click the **MongoDB CLI** button (below the **Create** button from the previous step) to connect to the database using the mongosh CLI.

Load sample data into the **training** database.

```
1 use training
2 db.marks.insert({"name":"Ramesh","subject":"maths","marks":87})
3 db.marks.insert({"name":"Ramesh","subject":"english","marks":59})
4 db.marks.insert({"name":"Ramesh","subject":"science","marks":77})
5 db.marks.insert({"name":"Rav","subject":"maths","marks":62})
6 db.marks.insert({"name":"Rav","subject":"english","marks":83})
7 db.marks.insert({"name":"Rav","subject":"science","marks":71})
8 db.marks.insert({"name":"Alison","subject":"maths","marks":84})
9 db.marks.insert({"name":"Alison","subject":"english","marks":82})
10 db.marks.insert({"name":"Alison","subject":"science","marks":86})
11 db.marks.insert({"name":"Steve","subject":"maths","marks":81})
12 db.marks.insert({"name":"Steve","subject":"english","marks":89})
13 db.marks.insert({"name":"Steve","subject":"science","marks":77})
14 db.marks.insert({"name":"Jan","subject":"english","marks":0,"reason":"absent"})
```

Exercise 2 - Limiting the rows in the output

Using the **\$limit** operator we can limit the number of documents printed in the output.

This command will print only 2 documents from the **marks** collection.

```
1 use training
2 db.marks.aggregate([{"$limit":2}])
```

Exercise 3 - Sorting based on a column

We can use the **\$sort** operator to sort the output.

This command sorts the documents based on field marks in ascending order.

```
1
2 db.marks.aggregate([{"$sort":{"marks":1}}])
```

This command sort the documents based on field marks in descending order.

```
1
2 db.marks.aggregate([{"$sort":{"marks":-1}}])
```

Exercise 4 - Sorting and limiting

Aggregation usually involves using more than one operator.

A pipeline consists of one or more operators declared inside an array.

The operators are comma separated.

Mongodb executes the first operator in the pipeline and sends its output to the next operator.

Let us create a two stage pipeline that answers the question "What are the top 2 marks?".

```
1 db.marks.aggregate([
2   {"$sort":{"marks":-1}},
3   {"$limit":2}
4 ])
5
6
7 # Exercise 5 - Group by
8
9 The operator $group by, along with operators like $sum, $avg, $min, $max, allows us to perform grouping operations.
10
11 This aggregation pipeline prints the average marks across all subjects.
12
13
14
15 db.marks.aggregate([
16 {
17   "$group":{
18     "_id":"$subject",
19     "average":{"$avg":"$marks"}
20   }
21 }
22 ])
```

The above query is equivalent to the below sql query.

```
SELECT subject, average(marks)
FROM marks
GROUP BY subject
```

Exercise 6 - Putting it all together

Now let us put together all the operators we have learnt to answer the question. "Who are the top 2 students by average marks?"
This involves:

- finding the average marks per student.
- sorting the output based on average marks in descending order.
- limiting the output to two documents.

```
1 db.marks.aggregate([
2   {
3     "$group": {
4       "_id": "$name",
5       "average": { "$avg": "$marks" }
6     }
7   },
8   {
9     "$sort": { "average": -1 }
10  },
11  {
12    "$limit": 2
13  }
14 ])
```

Practice exercises

1. Problem:

Find the total marks for each student across all subjects.

▼ Click here for Hint

use the \$sum operator along with \$group on the field 'name'

▼ Click here for Solution

On the mongo client run the below commands.

```
1 db.marks.aggregate([
2   {
3     "$group": { "_id": "$name", "total": { "$sum": "$marks" } }
4   }
5 ])
```

2. Problem:

Find the maximum marks scored in each subject.

▼ Click here for Hint

use the \$max operator along with \$group on the field 'subject'

▼ Click here for Solution

On the mongo client run the below commands.

```
1 db.marks.aggregate([
2   {
3     "$group":{"_id":"$subject","max_marks":{"$max":"$marks"}}
4   }
5 ])
```

3. Problem:

Find the minimum marks scored by each student.

▼ Click here for Hint

use the \$min operator along with \$group on the field 'name'

▼ Click here for Solution

On the mongo client run the below commands.

```
1 db.marks.aggregate([
2   {
3     "$group":{"_id":"$name","min_marks":{"$min":"$marks"}}
4   }
5 ])
```

4. Problem:

Find the top two subjects based on average marks.

▼ Click here for Hint

use the \$average operator along with \$group on the field 'subject'. Sort by average descending. Limit output to 2 documents

▼ Click here for Solution

On the mongo client run the below commands.

```
1 db.marks.aggregate([
2   {
3     "$group":{
4       "_id":"$subject",
5       "average":{"$avg":"$marks"}
6     }
7   },
8   {
9     "$sort":{"average":-1}
10  },
11  {
12    "$limit":2
13  }
14 ])
```

5. Problem:

Disconnect from the mongodb server.

▼ Click here for Hint

Refer to the [MongoDB Getting Started lab](#).

▼ Click here for Solution

Run the below command on the terminal.

```
1 exit
```